

1. The Canadian Council of Ministers of Environment led by federal, provincial, and territorial actors (FPT), is an intergovernmental body assigned to address Canadian environmental issues. (1) This includes addressing national issues such as climate change, waste reduction and recovery, air quality, and access to clean water. Since its founding in 1964, its central objective concentrates on national and international environmental concerns; demonstrating its strength in upholding organizational objectives, particularly during the Canada-Wide Action Program on Zero Waste in 2019. Indeed, the CCME gathers its 14 environmental ministers every year to analyze salient issues and to highlight Canada-wide environmental priorities. The CCME body is run by appointed ministers rather than democratically elected members, and the president is appointed through an annual rotation among the 14 members. (1) To enumerate, the process of decision-making within the organization is not democratic or transparent. The CCME infrastructure allows ministers to acknowledge the needs of specific interest groups but to also act on their own will rather than requiring ministers to act on the needs and expectations of the Canadian citizenry. Further, the CCME body obstructs indigenous peoples' participation in the procedural processes leading to enforcing policies without concerning their vote. Thus, indigenous groups can only voice their grievances about goals and influence people responsible for executing those policies. In conclusion, the CCME intergovernmental agreement reports on progress each year, exhibiting a collective willingness across FPT to help ensure the progression of its arrangement, namely through the Canada Wide Action program, and to demonstrate accountability to Canadian society for achieving long-term environmental goals, both national and international.

2. The Established Programs Financing Act, introduced in 1977 and led by Prime Minister Pierre Elliott Trudeau, is a financing program assigned with the redistribution of fiscal resources addressing provincial health care and high-education systems. (2) The EPF, introduced by federal Liberals, equipped the provinces with funding formulas that ensued based on shared cost programs that were then supplied through payments by fiscal transfers, such as tax points and cash transfers. (2) Notably, it also provided an increased amount of federal funding transfers to provinces for their provision of programs and services in accordance with the gross national economy. Although, reducing federal revenues. “Provinces received 13.5 percentage points of personal income tax (PIT) and 1 percentage point of corporate income tax (CIT), including some points carried over from the previous post-secondary education program.” (3) The EPF’s purpose was concentrated on advancing provincial and federal freedom in funding of established programs. (2) Namely, the EPF operated through requirements by certain principles; such as comprehensiveness, universality, accessibility, portability, public administration. (4) However, it also allowed provinces to have more independence in setting their policies and federal government to have more freedom in controlling its shared costs. The EPF has demonstrated its strength by replacing conditional federal funding for provinces in provincial health care and post-secondary education systems with federal periodic cash payments and tax point transfers. In conclusion, the EPF arrangement towards a shared responsibility between the two levels of government remains an important discussion leaving it up to the ministers to act appropriately based on their own preferences and agency to address payments through fiscal transfers.

3. The Congress of Aboriginal Peoples, introduced in 1971, is a forum established to represent the interests of Metis, status and non-status Indians, and Southern Inuit Indigenous People living off-reserve in Canada. The CAP's principal objective is to ameliorate the socio-economic conditions of all diverse indigenous identities and to emphasize equal presentation and cooperation of indigenous persons in Canada. This includes working collectively with 11 provincial and territorial organizations across Canada to promote and advance the common interests, collective and individual rights, and needs of its constituents. (5) Its objective has served to maintain an official membership between federal, provincial, and territorial actors (FPT) and to secure funding from the federal government. The CAP is one of the five National Indigenous Representative Organizations recognized by the government of Canada, a specific forum for greater cooperation with its affiliate organizations. (5) This means they would have the ability to participate in FPT regulation procedures and can encourage policies. Notably, CAP has demonstrated its strength in upholding its organizational objectives by prioritizing six universal themes acknowledged within the National Action Plan. (9) Since its founding, CAP has published its own declaration of rights for Metis and non-status Indians, accomplished special consultative status with the United Nations Economic Council (ECOSOC), advocated for women, administered the (ASETS), intervened in several important court cases associated with aboriginal rights, and prevailed in the Daniels v. Canada legal battle that recognized Indians are under federal responsibility. (5) In conclusion, the CAP's forum actively engages in legal research and entails continuous political action to anticipate secured protection and respect of the rights of constituents for indigenous persons.